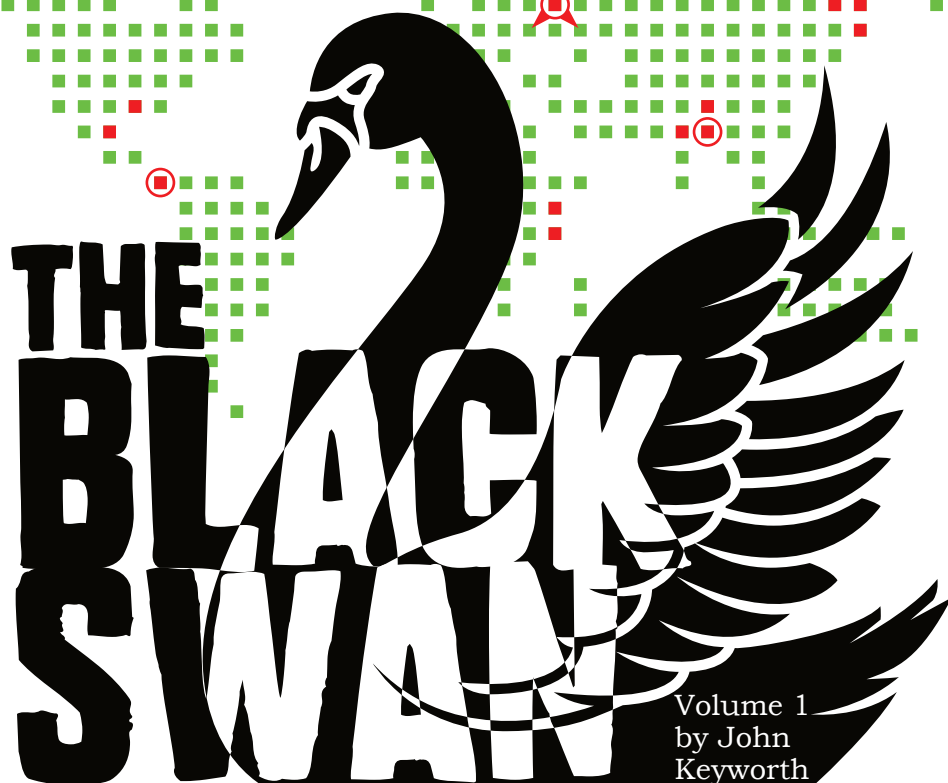


PLAYER'S GUIDE



THE BLACK SWAN

Volume 1
by John
Keyworth

CRISIS

A **Black Swan** is an event that is **impossible to predict** and has a **dramatic impact**.

12-32 players, 3 hours, 2-4 facilitators

- 2-3 Crisis Zone Maps, 1 Global Map
- 4-10 teams

Global Powers	2	Rules Guide	6
U.S.A.	2	Team Phase	6
China	2	Action Phase	6
European Union	2	Action Check	7
Global Relief Front	2	Map Rules	8
BrightStar Security	2	Opportunities	9
Helixx Solutions	2	Military Units	9
International Organisations	2	Credits	9
Potential Crisis Zones	3		
Democratic Republic of Namoro	3		
Republic of Karavara	4		
Republic of San Cordoba	5		



GLOBAL POWERS



U.S.A.

The United States is the dominant military and economic force on the planet. It has the clout to act alone when it suits — and the habit of doing so.

Its domestic politics are increasingly unstable, though, which makes it prone to looking inward in a crisis.



CHINA

China is patient. It has been building influence for decades through investment, trade, and political pressure, and it is starting to pay off.

It is extremely sensitive to anything that looks like interference in its internal affairs, or a challenge to Chinese sovereignty.



EUROPEAN UNION

The European Union acts through humanitarian aid, and economic pressure, rather than military force.

Its economic and diplomatic weight is significant, and member states can bring considerable pressure to bear when they act together.

INTERNATIONAL ORGANISATIONS

GLOBAL RELIEF FRONT

An international aid organisation. They go where the need is, regardless of who is in charge.

BRIGHTSTAR SECURITY

A private military corporation. They go where states won't.



HELIXX SOLUTIONS

A vast multinational that does a little of everything — infrastructure, logistics, technology, security consulting.

POTENTIAL CRISIS ZONES



DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC OF NAMBORO

Namboro is a mid-sized south east African state spanning arid lowlands, mineral rich mountains, and a cyclone-prone coastline.

It is a country with a proud maritime history, whose coastal traders once connected the Indian Ocean world, and whose highland communities have maintained distinct musical and oral traditions.

Its economy depends on mining in the mountains, with a single rail line stretching to the coast for export, and the majority of the population are subsistence farmers, nearer the coast.

Namboro is nominally democratic, but its fragmented power is split between a weak central government and influential regional governors (often styled Warlords in the press).

The Upper Kitale Highlands where most of the wealth is generated, as a result of several free trade deals, is mostly controlled by business interests.

The Lower Sereko Delta region has the bulk of the population and is dominated by swampy slum areas, dominated by local gangs.

Civil societies in Namboro, particularly mining communities and coastal fishing cooperatives, do exist to resist these negative forces, but their efforts remain local and fragmentary.





REPUBLIC OF KARAVARA

Karavara is a densely populated Southeast Asian state positioned on critical land and sea trade routes.

Karavara is known for its elaborate harvest festivals, its canal-city architecture, and a literary tradition that has historically bridged the highland and lowland communities.

It spans from coastal plains to resource-rich highlands on its borders.

Chronic inequality and uneven development have fuelled persistent tensions between the capital and peripheral regions.

Politically, Karavara is shaped by weak civil institutions and a dominant military that presents itself as the guardian of national unity.

NATIONAL DEFENCE FORCE

The National Defence Force are the armed forces of Karavara and protect the nation from external threats, but also style themselves as the keepers of Karavaran Democracy and have historically taken charge when the nation faces internal strife.

KARAVARAN PEOPLE'S ASSEMBLY

The People's Assembly is a loose alliance that combines many armed groups from rural areas in Karavara that see the government as an oppressive force and its democracy as a bad joke.



REPUBLIC OF SAN CORDOBA

San Cordoba is a small but significant Central American country stretching between the Pacific and Caribbean, defined by volcanic mountains, dense rain forests, and coastal

ports.

San Cordoba is home to one of the region's oldest universities and a vibrant mural art tradition through which political movements have historically communicated with the public.

The country's politics are marked by political and financial corruption, and sharp social divides between urban centres, rural communities, and indigenous populations.

GUARDIA CIVIL

The Guardia Civil is a military organisation responsible for policing San Corboba, but can also be called up as the national army in times of war. It has a reputation for ruthlessness, but the Guardia cites the prevalence of gangs and rebels as forcing it to act with a strong hand.

SOCIALIST ALLIANCE

The Socialist Alliance is a recent attempt to combine unions, community groups and student organisations into a force that can fight back against government corruption through protest, industrial action and political pressure.



RULES GUIDE

The game is split into 5 thirty minute turns, each with 2 timed phases:

- Team Phase (10 minute)
- Action Phase (20 minute)

TEAM PHASE

The facilitators will announce any news from the last turn.

Each player reclaims one of their resource cards to their hand.

Discuss things with your team.

ACTION PHASE

Place action and resources cards on a map. A facilitator will call you up.

- Multiple players can contribute action and/or resource cards to the same action.
- An action must have at least 1 action cards.
 - All action cards must be from the current turn.
- All resource card must be of a different colour.
 - A player doesn't need to have used their action card to contribute a resource card.
- Actions are placed at the end of the queue.

Facilitators will call players to the map to resolve their actions.

LAST TURN BONUS

Actions placed in the first 5 minutes of the last turn gain a +1 bonus to Impact.

Actions cannot be placed after the first 10 minutes of the action phase in the last turn.

RESOURCE CARD KEYWORDS

Discard: Discard the card after use, you can reclaim it in a later Team Phase.

Keep: Keep the card after use.

Trash: Discard the card after use, it cannot be reclaimed.

Trade-able: Can be given to other players, but cannot be passed on if you aren't the original owner.

Local: Can only be used on the map that matches its flag.

ACTION CHECK

In the order they were placed, the facilitator for a map will call up players to resolve actions.

1. Communicate your action to the facilitator, this can be anything that makes sense.
 - A player with an action card in an action can choose to betray that action, they will take the cards they contributed out of this action and resolve a new action simultaneously.
2. The action's impact will be calculated by the facilitator.
 - All Action Card bonuses + one Resource Card bonus (per different flag) - Difficulty
3. You then roll the consequence dice and consult the following table:
 - 1-2 unexpected consequence
 - 3-4 no extra effect
 - 5-6 +2 impact
4. The facilitator will then tell you the result of your action based on the final impact:

	Effect	Impact
Trivial	<i>barely a ripple</i> Any effects will be short lived and soon forgotten.	0-1
Minor	<i>a small shift</i> A subtle effect, minorly influencing events.	2-4
Moderate	<i>drawing attention</i> A meaningful effect that can shift the local balance of power.	5-7
Notable	<i>a turning point</i> A significant and eye catching effect that may have multiple effects.	8-11
Major	<i>a force to be reckoned with</i> Your action has a lasting effect with significant consequences.	12-15
Radical	<i>game changing</i> Can fundamentally change the political or strategic landscape.	16+

5. Reclaim your action card.



MAP RULES

Each map has areas for the local teams and regions, and each has scores that can be modified by actions.

TEAM SCORES

Stability: Determines if the team gains or loses extra resource cards each turn.

0-10	Discard 1 resource card per turn.
11-30	No effect.
31-50	Recover 1 additional resource card per turn.
51+	Recover 2 additional resource cards per turn.

Military Deployment: Only for teams with a significant professional military force. Changing this value is usually controlled by the nation's government (and the faction controlling it) and grants the military player more *units* and/or *resource cards*.

REGION SCORES

Economy: The strength of the economy determines the local prosperity.

The region with the strongest economy, globally, will gain an *opportunity* each round.

0-2	Collapse
3-8	Poverty
9-15	Poor
16-30	OK
31-50	Well Off
51+	Wealthy

Military Control: Which team controls this region, and how well.

- There may be extra *resource cards* available for controlling a region, as listed on the map.

OTHER SCORES

Political Control: this determines which faction controls the government of a nation.

- A faction in control by at least 2 points gains a *opportunity* each turn.
- 8 If there is no clear controller, the nation will suffer each turn.

OPPORTUNITIES

Opportunities are presented to players who dominate certain map scores - world economics or a national government, for instance - and grant them a special ability to use once per turn.

Opportunity cards will be distributed by the facilitator team and see a facilitator to use an ability.

MILITARY UNITS

Military Units can be redeployed to any region by their owner and grant an impact bonus to the owner's actions in that region - although the bonus can be rejected, or reduced, by the facilitator resolving the action if using soldiers is not appropriate.

CREDITS

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